

6. Modern javelins are made of aluminium alloys or aluminium composite materials.

(a) Describe what is meant by the term 'composite material'.

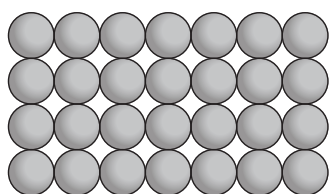
[2]

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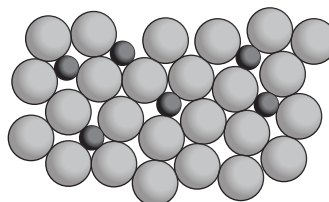
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(b) Pure aluminium is too flexible to make javelins. Copper can be mixed with aluminium to produce an alloy.



Pure aluminium



Copper and aluminium alloy

Use the diagrams and your own knowledge of alloys to explain how the presence of copper atoms in the aluminium results in the alloy being more rigid than pure aluminium.

[3]

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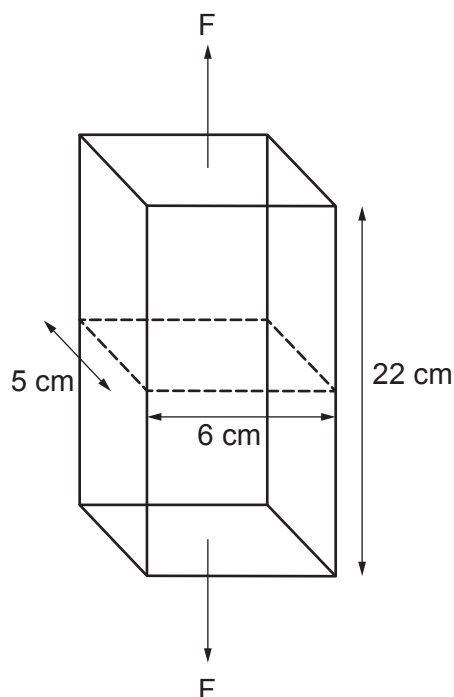
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- (c) An engineer was asked to determine the force required to break a pure aluminium rectangular bar.



The tensile strength of pure aluminium is 90 MN/m^2 .

Use the information above and the equation

$$\text{tensile strength} = \frac{\text{force}}{\text{cross-sectional area}}$$

to calculate the force (F) required to break this bar.

[6]

($1 \text{ MN} = 10^6 \text{ N}$ and $1 \text{ cm}^2 = 10^{-4} \text{ m}^2$).

force (F) = N

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Key

Symbol	Name	Z	A_r
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atomic number